

the NT Text down through the centuries was essentially normal, from the very start, the conviction about pedigree would be based upon historical evidence. When the Autographs were penned, there were no NT lections. The idea of adding lection markers had to come later; just how much later we have no way of knowing. Somewhere along the line, the first such MS was produced. Was the idea so brilliant that it spread like wild fire? Or did the idea spread slowly? We have no way of knowing.

It should be obvious to everyone that preparing a copy in two colors with an elaborate apparatus will take more time and effort than a copy in one color without that apparatus. So why would people do it? There had to be a demand for such copies. A MS with a liturgical apparatus was obviously prepared to be used for public reading, to be read aloud to an audience. For private reading and study you want a text without interruptions. Von Soden actually noted that the individual letters in his **K<sup>r</sup>** MSS tended to be somewhat larger than in non-**K<sup>r</sup>** MSS. So why would that be? Presumably to facilitate the public reading. In any case, books that are used wear out. So much so, that monasteries that used a specific text-type for their public reading would be sure to make and keep a number of back-up copies on hand. There would not be the same motivation for text-types that were not used. That may be why **f<sup>35</sup>/K<sup>r</sup>** is by far the largest family within the Byzantine tradition, and is the only family that has so far been demonstrated to exist in all 27 books.<sup>1</sup>

CONCLUSION: Von Soden's characterization of his **K<sup>r</sup>** as a late revision is simply false. It follows that all informed persons should stop using the symbol **K<sup>r</sup>**.

## Copyist Care Quotient

For some time I have been of the opinion that the question of the mentality that a copyist brought to his task deserves far more attention than it has so far received. If we can agree that the job of a copyist is to reproduce the exemplar that he is copying, then it should be possible to evaluate his failures in so doing. Of course such evaluation depends on the known existence of his exemplar, or of the archetype of the family to which the copy belongs (as determined by its mosaic or profile). Where there is a line of transmission descending from an archetype, a given variant could have been in the exemplar, of course, but I see no way of controlling for that possibility, at the moment. A 'variant' is defined by its departure from

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<sup>1</sup> Just by the way, it is common knowledge that the Lectionaries contain no lections from the Apocalypse. What few people know is that some **f<sup>35</sup>** MSS do contain a liturgical apparatus in the Apocalypse. Might this be something that deserves further study?